Functions: one job each

Programming · Level 3 · Lesson 1



In this lesson you will

- Define functions with parameters and return a result.
- Tell return from print.
- Test a function with assert.

Key ideas

- return hands the result back; print only shows it.
- No return means None.
- Test the edges: empty, one item, negatives.

Activity: Function machines

1. Warm-up (3 min): Guess the rule of a mystery “function machine”.
2. Write (7 min): Write the function and three asserts.
3. Break (7 min): Swap; try to break your partner’s function.
4. Fix (3 min): Fix it so every assert passes.

The warm-up works with no phone at all: input in, output out.

Let’s discuss

1. Why is return more useful than print inside a function?
2. Which edge case broke a function today?
3. How do you choose a good name for a function?

Exit ticket

- Write a function that returns the bigger of two numbers, and one assert for it.